

of thought. In this context, a structured MOOC might be beneficial to a self-motivated student who believes in planning and organising the way he wants to study, but it will hardly appeal to a student who needs motivation and has issues with self-responsibility when it comes to learning. A large number of students who form the core target group for the online education market fall into the latter category.

Too reliant on technology

The role of technology in shaping the future of education is undeniable but too much dependence on technology might prove to be a bane. An online course setup is almost entirely based on the internet. It uses technology for every single component – be it grading, reviewing, outreach or course content preparation. A failure of one component could trigger off a cascading effect and affect other components. A programming bug might create a mess of the quiz grades, a technical glitch might lead to improper delivery of content, server issues might lead to shutdown of a session altogether, etc. Too many things could go wrong.

Another compelling argument is that online education's reliance on technology can limit its outreach. Underdeveloped regions in dire need of a basic educational setup may not be able to access the growing network of online education. Traditional educational groundwork and schools might be the only answer in such cases.

